

choose a domain name that includes the words “fix” and “bike.” A short name that is simple, easy to type, and memorable is best. You should also avoid numbers and hyphens, since they can be confusing.

Select the appropriate domain extension for the business. Commercial businesses tend to use “.com,” whereas “.net” is more appropriate for internet, email, and networking services. If you want to appeal to a more local audience, there are also country- and even region-specific extensions, such as “.ca” for a business in Canada or “.uk” for one in the UK.

To obtain your domain name, visit a domain name registrar, check whether your preferred domain name is available, and pay a fee to lease the name. You will also need to use a web-hosting service, which allows your website to be accessed on the web. Some companies provide both hosting and domain names.

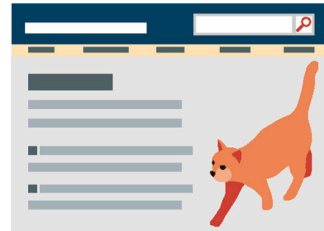


WHICH TYPE OF WEBSITE?

Your website’s purpose will influence the design and whether the site is static (always shows the same content) or dynamic (shows different content according to the user). Many sites that aim to provide information, called content websites, are static, while e-commerce sites—online shops—tend to be dynamic, with pages tailored to the needs of individual customers who visit the site.

Content websites

A content site might give a general overview of a topic, such as caring for cats; focus on a specific aspect, such as breeds; or narrow to key terms, such as a particular breed. You can secure funding for content sites in various ways: a cat site, for example, might be funded by a pet food company or have links to an e-commerce site. Other ways to generate income include advertising and affiliate marketing (see p.35). If your site is instructional, you might offer products, such as e-books, or services, such as courses, seminars, or consultancy. Social media offers another way to be visible (see pp.140–141).



E-commerce websites

An e-commerce site showcases goods, such as pet foods, and allows customers to make online purchases. Like real storefronts, such sites need to be eye-catching and regularly updated. The ordering and payment process should be straightforward and hassle-free (via a trusted system, such as PayPal) with a clear return/refund policy.

